



Who Builds AI and Whose Values Get Embedded?



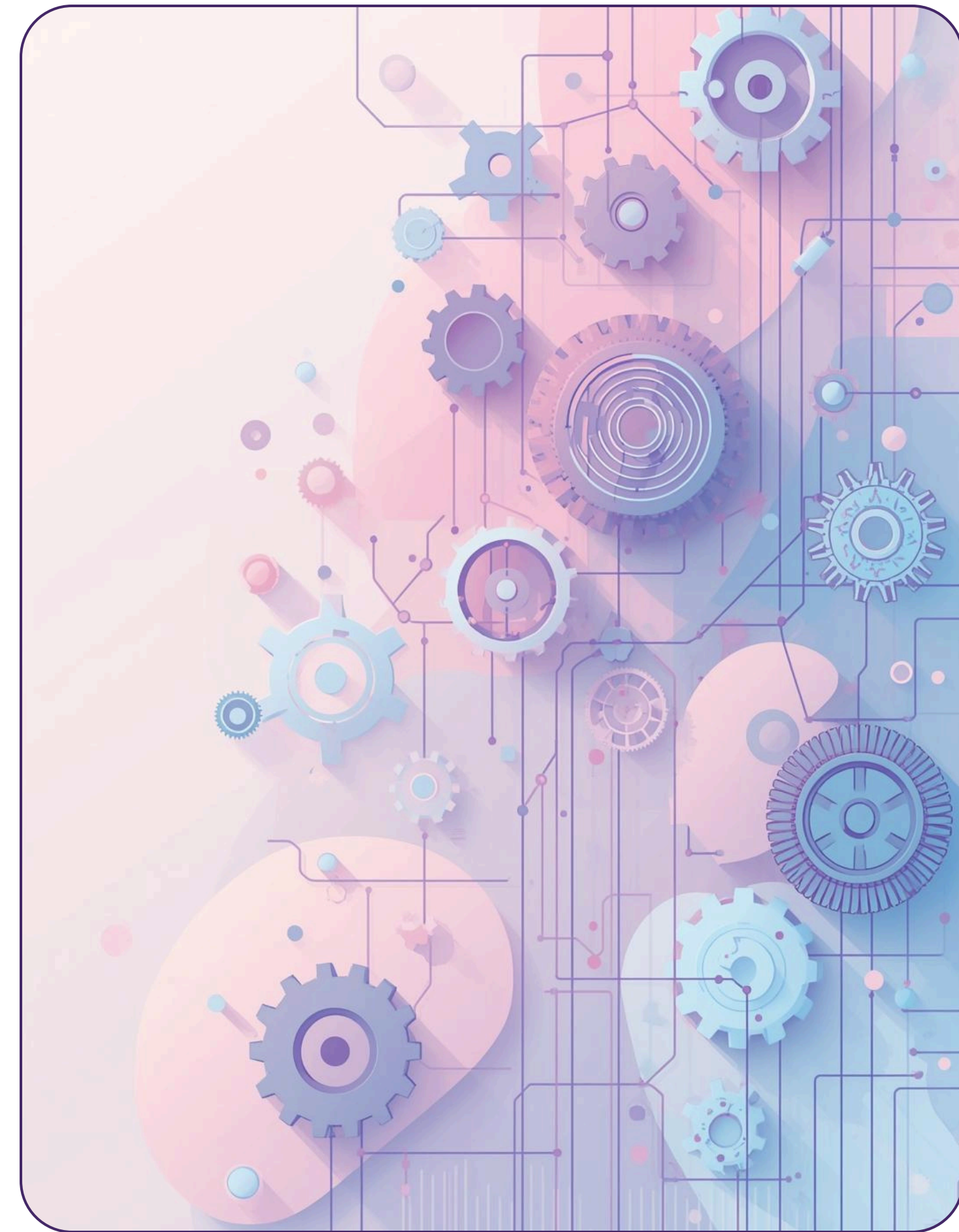
The Concentration Problem

AI development is dominated by:

- A handful of US companies (Google, Meta, Microsoft, Amazon, OpenAI, Anthropic)
- Chinese tech giants (Baidu, Alibaba, Tencent)
- Concentrated in San Francisco and Beijing
- Built by predominantly male, elite-educated engineers

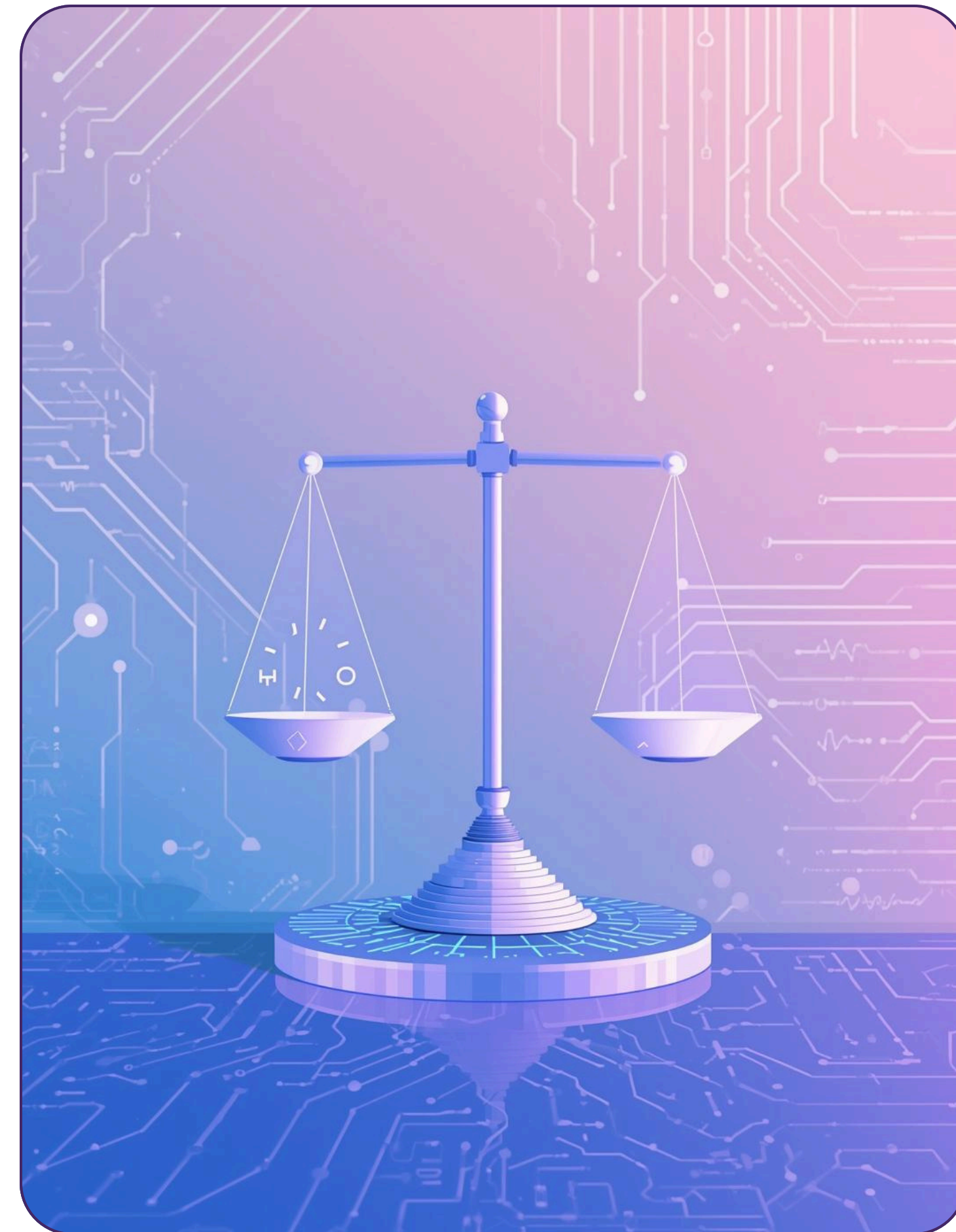
Why this Matters

- Their values and blind spots shape global AI
- Facial recognition: 34% higher error rates for dark-skinned women (Joy Buolamwini)
- Voice assistants initially struggled with women's voices
- Problems affecting marginalized groups discovered late or ignored



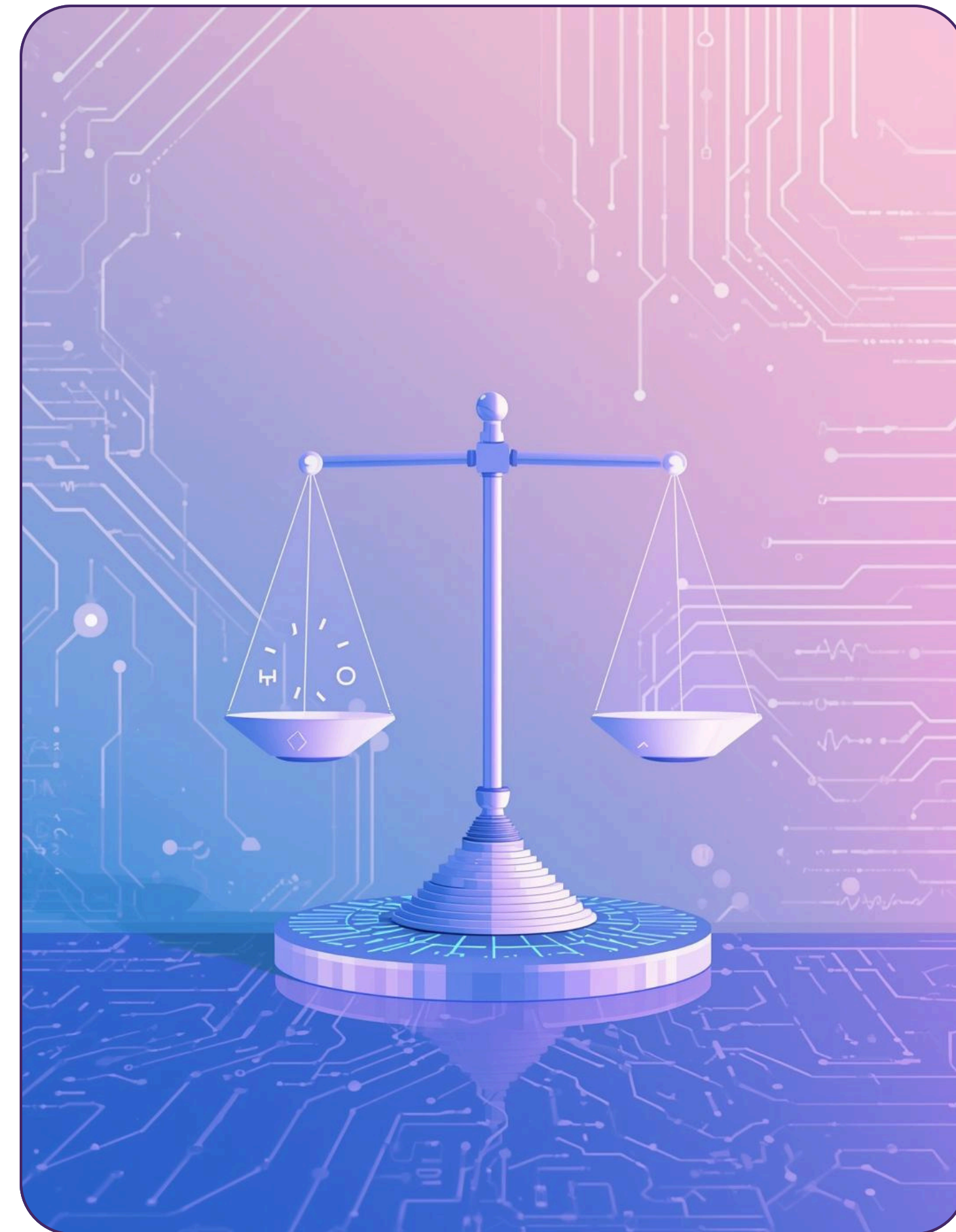
Values Get Embedded Through:

- Problem selection: What gets built?
 - Facial recognition (surveillance) vs. accessibility tools
 - Advertising optimization vs. scientific research tools
 - Autonomous weapons vs. medical diagnosis



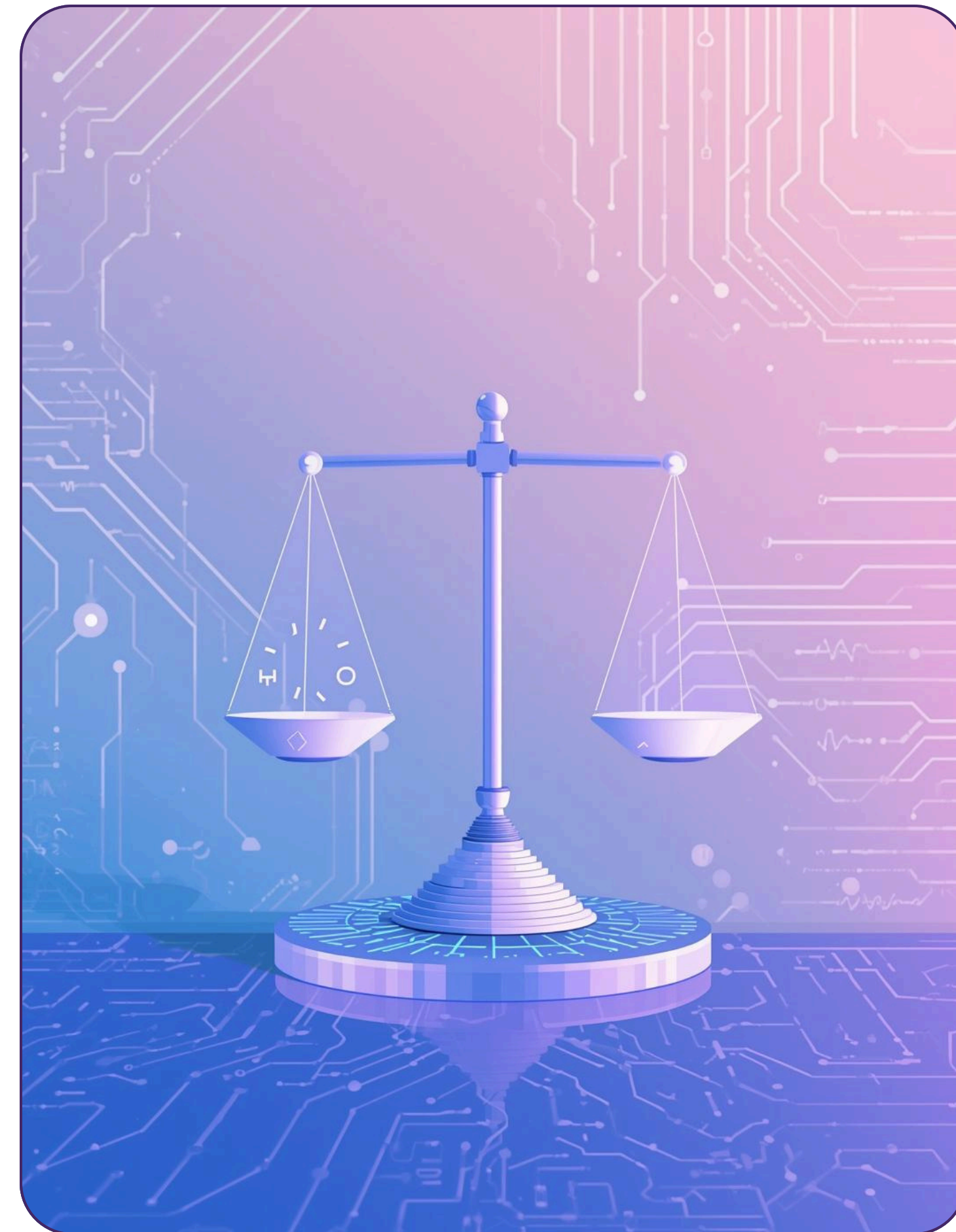
Values Get Embedded Through:

- Design choices: How is it built?
 - What counts as "success"?
 - Which risks are prioritized?
 - What tradeoffs are acceptable?



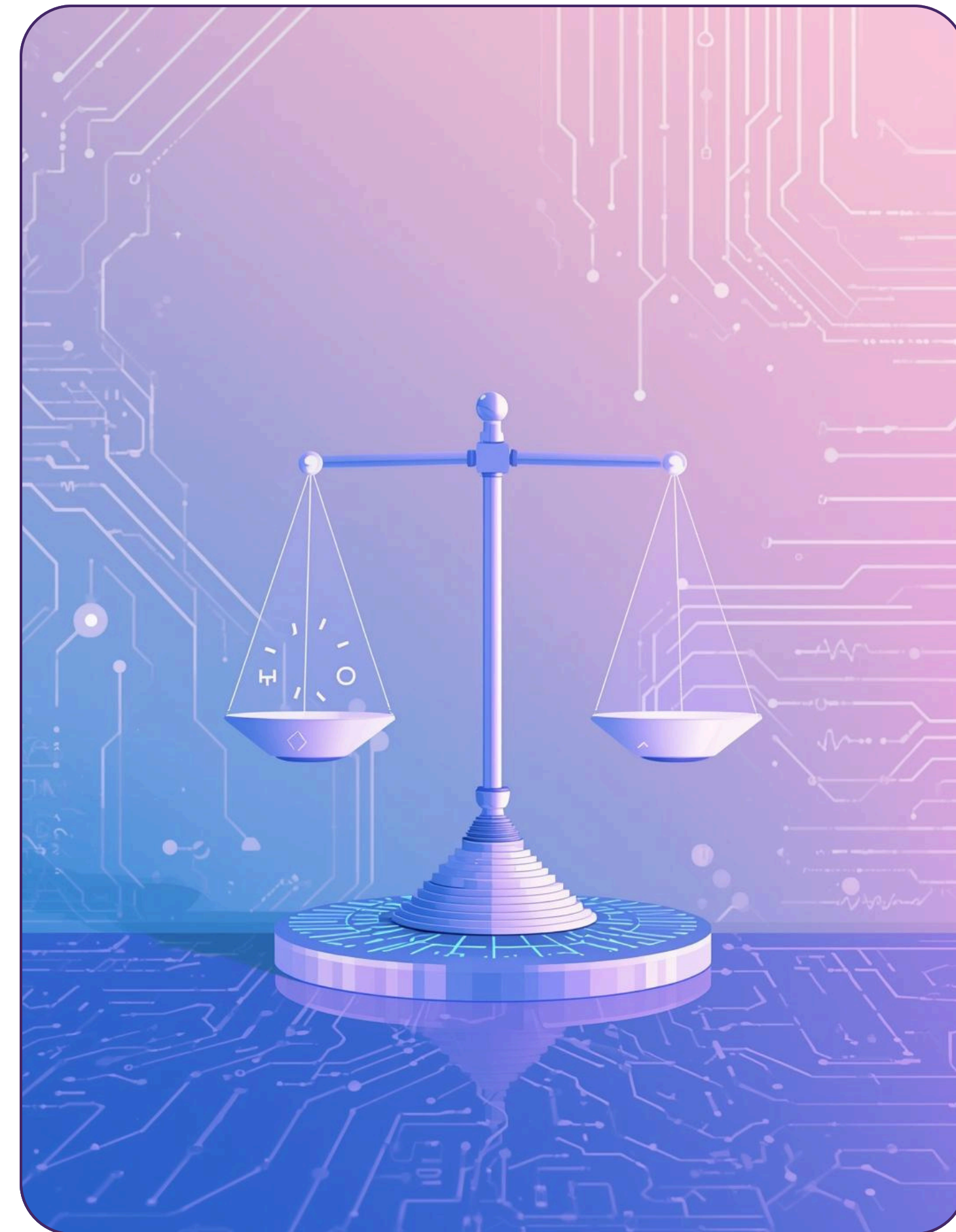
Values Get Embedded Through:

- Training data: What patterns does it learn?
 - Historical biases in data
 - Overrepresentation of some groups, underrepresentation of others
 - What's measured and what's ignored?



Values Get Embedded Through:

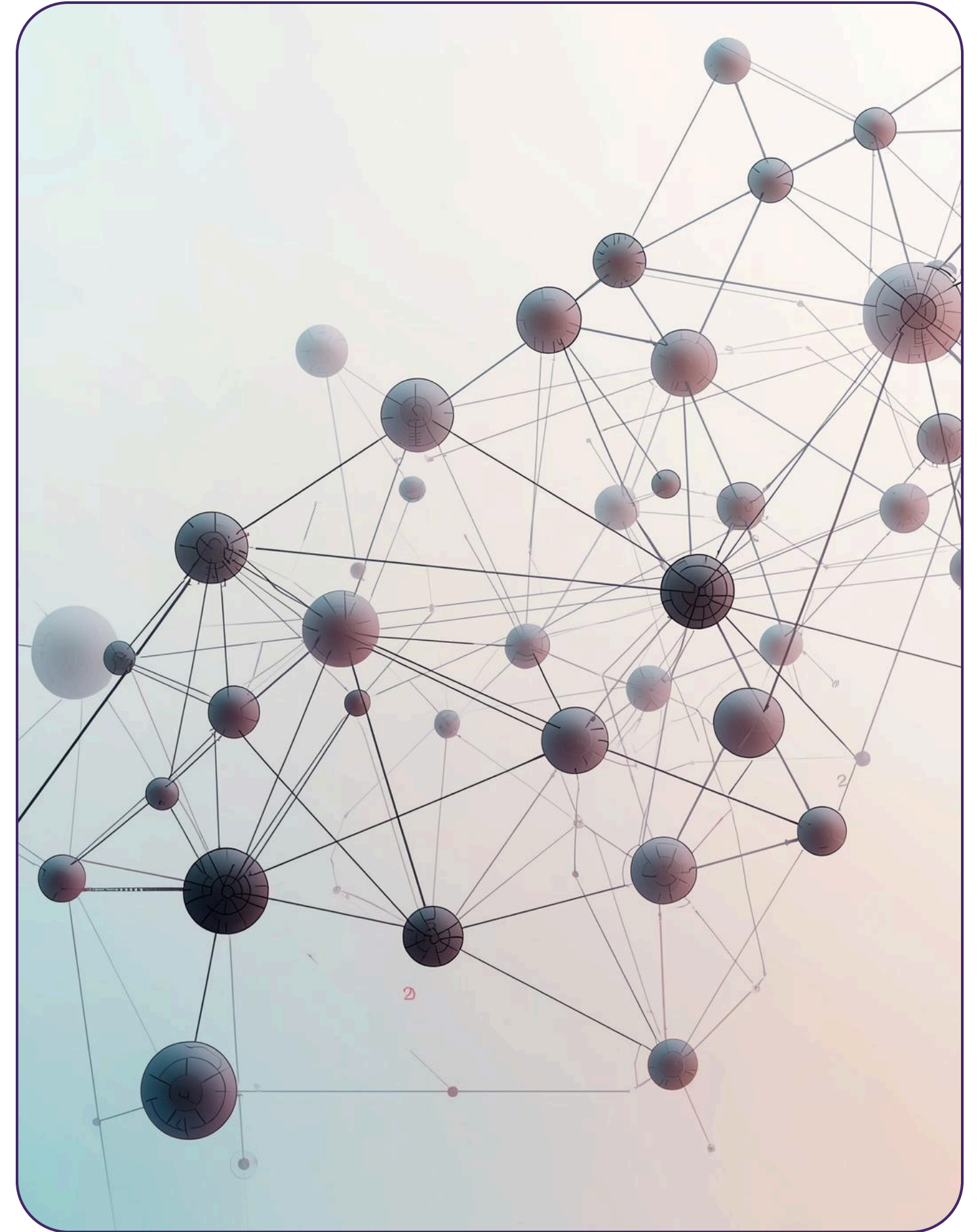
- Deployment decisions: Where and how is it used?
 - Which communities get beneficial AI vs. surveillance AI?
 - Terms of service, pricing, access



Predictive Policing

Values embedded at each stage:

- Problem: "Reduce crime" assumes more policing is the solution
- Design: Optimizes for arrests/stops, not community safety or trust
- Data: Historical arrest data reflects biased policing practices
- Deployment: Targeted at poor/minority neighborhoods, not white-collar crime



Predictive Policing

Result: System that reinforces and amplifies existing inequities while appearing "objective."

